1.4 THEORIES OF CLOTHING

Clothing theories are developed based upon the use and growth of clothing. The four major theories of clothing are modesty, immodesty, and adornment and protection theory.

1.4.1 Modesty Theory

The basic importance of clothing is to cover or conceal the private parts of the human body.

Example: Leaves used around the waist and bust, by Stone Age women as clothing.

1.4.2 Immodesty Theory

Historical records on clothing, mention about clothing used to attract opposite sex. According to this theory the basic idea of clothing is attraction seeking.

Example: Tight fitting pants and garments which expose body parts.

1.4.3 Adornment Theory

Right from the origin of mankind, people were trying to beautify themselves. Clothing has always supported this idea and helped one to form beautiful appearance. Wearing beautiful garments gives an aesthetic appearance.

Example: Decorated blouse with embroidery and stone work.

1.4.4 Protection Theory

Clothes have always been used for protection against extreme climatic conditions such as winter, rainy and summer. Exposure to dangerous materials and environment such as furnace, boiler and thermals stations require special clothing.

Example: Woolen coats – winter season, rain coats – rainy season and boiler suits – for people working in a furnace.

1.5 CLASSIFICATION OF CLOTHING

Clothing is classified based on the following five aspects:

1. Based on method of wearing.
2. Based on the area of usage.
3. Based on gender.
4. Based on occasion.
5. Based on occupation.

1.5.1 Clothing based upon the Method of Wearing

Clothing can be grouped based upon the method it is worn. They are draped clothing, slip on clothing, open stitched clothing, closed clothing and sheath clothing.

1.5.1.1 Draped Clothing

Draped clothing is clothes which run into meters and are draped over the body or certain method of wearing.

Example: Indian saree draping Maharashtra – Saree is pleated and tucked between legs ; Gujarath – Saree pallu is draped, over the bust from right side shoulder ; Tamil Nadu – Saree is pleated in front and draped over left shoulder **(Figure 1.11)**.



Figure 1.11 Draped Clothing

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